AE 162 BASIC AGRICULTURE

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DEVELOPMENT OF AGRICULTURE

BEGINNING OF AGRICULTURE

Agriculture has gone through many changes since early man started hunting and gathering.

Beginning of Agriculture

- **In the beginning man did not have farms from which he got food because he was nomadic moving from place to place in search of food.**

- **Food comprised wild fruits, honey and animals from which he got killed during hunting through chasing and trapping.**

Beginning of Agriculture …

- **On his rounds, he caught young animals and brought them home to rear them to use as food.**

- **The dog was the first animal early man domesticated to become his best friend accompanying him when he went hunting for other wild animals.**

Beginning of Agriculture …

- **From these experiences, man learned to grow his own food and raise animals.**

Beginning of Agriculture …

- **Later, early man collected seed and fruits from crops which had grown from what he had thrown away.**

- **When this pleased him, he increased the crops and cared for them.**

Beginning of Agriculture …

- **This way, he got food always without having to move around (as nomads) to look for food.**

Beginning of Agriculture …

- The earliest agriculture tools were made from pieces of wood, stones and bones of animals.
- These were used to clear woods, cut trees and skin the animals killed.

Beginning of Agriculture …

- **The weapons were very simple; clubs and stones.**

Beginning of Agriculture …

- **Early farmers did not need to go about looking for fresh land to farm; they kept to one area of land (sedentary life).**
- **As the size of the family increased, the area of the land they needed to farm also increased.**

Beginning of Agriculture ...

- Gradually, man began to discover better methods of growing crops.
- He had no idea of rotation or manuring the soil.
- He realised that it was not good to grow the crops on the same piece of land.

Beginning of Agriculture …

- He found it wise to allow his farmland to rest after cultivating it for a year or two.
- The farmland was left to become overgrown with wild grasses and other plants (fallowing) helping to add plant nutrients to the soil.

SUBSISTENCE AGRICULTURE

Subsistence Agriculture

- **Subsistence agriculture is the practice whereby farmers grow food to feed their families using rudimentary tools.**
- **This type of agriculture started with the early farmers but it still exists in many West African countries including Ghana.**

Subsistence Agriculture …

- **Subsistence farmers may have other jobs.**
- **Subsistence farmers raise animals which sleep in trees and on their compound at the mercy of the weather.**

Subsistence Agriculture …

- **The feed for the animals are left-overs from the kitchen.**
- **These animals also feed free range on grass and insects in the field and their production is low.**

Subsistence Agriculture …

- **Some subsistence farmers produce what they need for food plus a little more for sale starting cash crop agriculture.**

CASH CROP AGRICULTURE

Cash Crop Agriculture

- **Plantation or cash crop agriculture is agriculture in which crops are grown for sale.**
- **A cash crop farmer may have other jobs.**

Cash Crop Agriculture

- **Plantations began when the white man saw tropical crops that could feed industries in his home country.**
- **As a result, farmers started growing these crops and sold them to the white man.**

Cash Crop Agriculture …

These crops included:

Cocoa	**Banana**	**Citrus Fruits**
Ginger	**Kola Nuts**	**Oil Palm**
Pepper	**Pineapples**	**Shea Butter**
Yam		

Cash Crop Agriculture …

Some of the countries which buy these crops from Ghana are

- **Britain**
- **China**
- **USA**
- **Holland**
- **Germany**

Commercial Agriculture

- **Commercial agriculture is where crops and animals are grown and reared on a large scale for sale.**
- **Farms are run by farm managers or entrepreneurs on business lines recording their cost of production and sales to assess profitability.**

COMMERCIAL AGRICULTURE

Commercial Agriculture

- **Machines are used on these farms.**

- **In addition to the machines used, large quantities of fertilisers, herbicides and insecticides are used on such farms.**

AGRICULTURAL DEVELOPMENT IN GHANA

Agricultural Development in Ghana

Hunting and gathering as part of agriculture in Ghana.

- **Many farmers in Ghana still hunt for wild animals and some set traps even today to kill animals of all kinds for food.**

Agricultural Development in Ghana

- **Men, women and children go out after rains with lamps to gather snails and mushrooms.**

Agricultural Development in Ghana

- **In the dry season, hunters from the north trek the plains searching for animals in the bush.**
- **Along the coast and in the forest areas farmers wait to collect coconuts, kola nuts and mangoes.**

SUBSISTENCE AGRICULTURE IN GHANA

Subsistence Agriculture in Ghana

- **Subsistence agriculture is still practised in Ghana.**
- **Their farms are small in size (smallholder) and in most cases they do not use fertilisers and therefore realise low yields.**

Subsistence Agriculture in Ghana …

- **Animals are also reared under subsistence agriculture on free range.**
- **At times, they are taken by hawks or bitten by snakes in the field.**
- **Because of this their owners get very little out of them.**

CASH CROP AGRICULTURE IN GHANA

Cash Crop Agriculture in Ghana

Several crops are produced today for sale.

- **At first the crops grown for sale were cocoa and oil palm.**
- **Crops like pineapple, kola, shea butter, banana, ginger, citrus, pepper, and garden eggs are grown for sale.**

Cash Crop Agriculture in Ghana

Several crops are produced today for sale.

Britain	**Germany**
Russia	**USA**
Burkina Faso	

are some countries which buy cash crops from Ghana.

COMMERCIAL AGRICULTURE IN GHANA

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana

Commercial agriculture is receiving attention today in Ghana.

- **Large areas are cleared to grow crops and also to raise animals for the production of meat and eggs.**

Commercial Agricultural in Ghana …

- Cassava, yam, ginger, pineapple, tomatoes, rice, pepper, onions, chickens, eggs, cattle, sheep and goats are some of the things they produce.
- These products are sold abroad while others are, however, sold in Ghana.

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana …

- One speciality about commercial agriculture is that it is run on business lines.
- Records of income and expenditure helps the entrepreneur to determine whether he is making a profit or loss.

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana …

- **If he discovers that he is making losses, he must reorganise so as to make profit.**

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana …

- **Akate Farms & Trading Company Ltd**
- **University of Ghana farms**
- **Green Gold Farms**
- **Srighan Farms (GH) Ltd**

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana …

- **Because large areas are cultivated for growing crops in this type of agriculture, machines like tractors, combine harvesters and others are used to work on the farms.**

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana …

Watch Video on combine harvesting

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_Qgpq4eXv-o

Commercial Agriculture in Ghana …

- **On such farms, large quantities of chemicals like fertilisers, herbicides and insecticides are used.**